John Neal

Senior Spatial & Interior Designer
(Retail | Hospitality | Workplace | Residential)

Nottingham, UK
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CV

PROFILE

Concept-led Senior Interior Designer with 20+ years' experience designing spaces across hospitality/F&B, workplace, wellness, retail and residential sectors. Strong from feasibility and space planning through developed design, technical coordination and site support. Confident balancing brand, lifestyle and operational needs, collaborating with clients, consultants, landlords and contractors to deliver buildable design that feels considered and engaging.

SELECTED PROJECTS

- **Crosslands Meadows (Residential)** – Extension + interior remodelling; led architectural and interior design, plus PM.
- **City Mall, St Petersburg (Mall Environment)** – Façade + interior redevelopment concept; layout input, finishes direction and landlord presentations.
- **Hammam Spa + Café Bibi (Hospitality)** – Feasibility + concept; spatial strategy, guest flow and materials/FF&E.
- **Links of London (Global Retail)** – Westfield flagship + international roll-out; developed standards/guidance for consistent, accessible brand delivery.
- **Arcadia (Retail Brands)** – Design Manager; delivered Sheffield Topshop/Topman refurbishment (Grade II listed) within multi-format programme.

DESIGN + DELIVERY STRENGTHS

- **Concept development:** Create functional, inspiring concepts with clear spatial direction and cohesive rationale.
- **Brief development, research and feasibility:** Shape briefs from site insight, testing options early against budget, programme and operational needs.
- **Spatial planning and user journey:** Plan layouts around real movement and use, balancing experience with practicality.
- **Statutory approvals and submissions:** Prepare landlord/stakeholder presentations and coordinate Planning and Building Control where required.
- **FF&E, materials and detailed design:** Develop palettes, specifications and details that are durable and deliverable.
- **Technical documentation:** Produce clear drawing packs, schedules and key details with version control.
- **Value engineering and design intent management:** Protect design intent while adapting to cost, lead times and build constraints.
- **Multi-project delivery and programme coordination:** Run multiple projects, keeping decisions clear and risks visible.

ELIGIBILITY AND FLEXIBILITY

- **UK:** Right to work | Full UK licence & own transport | Travel and flexible hours

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CORE

- **Concept development & rapid ideation**
- **Brief development, research & feasibility**
- **Spatial planning & user journey**
- **Site surveys & existing conditions**
- **Statutory approvals, landlord packs & Building Control liaison**
- **FF&E, materials & detailed design**
- **Standards, specifications & technical packs**
- **Value engineering & design intent management**
- **Multi-project delivery & programme coordination**

TOOLS

AutoCAD – Advanced level
SketchUp Pro – V-Ray; Enscape
Adobe CC – Photoshop; InDesign
Revit – Foundation level
Microsoft 365 – Word; Excel; Teams; SharePoint; PowerPoint
AI tools – Midjourney; Firefly

EDUCATION

- **BA (Hons) Interior Design**, De Montfort University (Leicester)
- **Erasmus Exchange**, Politecnico di Milano
- **Foundation Art & Design,** Loughborough University

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder / Director | Own Interior Design Ltd | Nottingham
Mar 2015 – Present
- Lead concept and technical design from feasibility through delivery; define scope, constraints and design intent early.
- Carry out measured check surveys where possible; develop coordinated drawing sets, FF&E intent and approval packs, including landlord submissions and Planning and Building Control liaison where required.
- Coordinate delivery: programme trackers, supplier liaison, site issue resolution and project admin (POs/invoicing).

Senior Store Designer | Lewis & Hickey Architects (Boots / Boots Opticians) / 2023 (6 months)
- Store refurb/roll-out support; 2D/3D visuals and coordinated drawing information for delivery and opening dates.

Senior Designer | Chapman Taylor
Nov 2017 – Mar 2018 (contract)
- Supported City Mall concept development with a focus on shopping mall planning and experience-led layout design.

Lead Designer, Global Store Design | Links of London
Jan 2017 – Nov 2017 (contract)
- Shaped customer-facing store concepts across multiple formats (flagship, standalone, concession, travel retail), including Heathrow T5.
- Communicated concepts through clear 2D/3D studies and documentation, contributing to global standards and consistent delivery across teams.

Freelance Senior Designer (various studios)
20.20 | Twelve Studio | Gary Porter Creative | Wanda Creative
Sept 2014 – Dec 2016
- Delivered retail design support across a number of projects including Sainsbury's, L-Living, Homebase and Thomas Cook.

Senior Design Manager | Zebra Projects
Oct 2013 – Aug 2014
- Managed design development and coordination activities for Arcadia Group brands for retail fit-out projects, supporting delivery both UK and international franchise projects.

Senior Interior Designer | Benoy
Nov 2012 – Oct 2013
- Creative input for international retail and commercial projects, from department store to large shopping mall environments.

EARLIER CAREER

Senior Interior Designer | FITCH (Mumbai & Singapore)
Jan - Oct 2012 (contract)

Senior Interior Designer | Henry Mein Partnership
2006 – 2011

Interior Designer | Leicester City Council – Architecture Group
2004 – 2006